

No number tallies up my score

Text: Ralph Waldo Emerson (1803-1882), alt.

Music: North American Traditional

RESIGNATION CMD

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The musical score is written for a single melodic line in treble clef and a bass line in bass clef, both in 3/4 time. The key signature has one flat (B-flat). The score is divided into four systems, each with four lines of lyrics. Chord symbols are placed above the staff at the beginning of each measure. The lyrics are written in a simple, sans-serif font, with hyphens indicating syllables that span across measures. The melody is a simple, folk-like tune, and the bass line provides a steady accompaniment.

C Am C Am C/G G C

1 No num - ber tal - lies up my score, no tribe my house can fill;
2 I wrote the past in char - ac - ters of rock and fire and scroll,
3 Must time and tide for - ev - er run, nor winds sleep in the west?
4 Blend war and trade and creeds and song, as rip - ens hu - man race,

C Am C Am C/G G C

I sit be - side the fount of life and pour the del - uge still.
the build - ing in the cor - al sea, the plant - ing of the coal.
Will ne'er my wheels which whirl the sun and sat - el - lites have rest?
the sun - burnt world that they shall breed, of all my count - less days.

C Am F Dm C Am C Dm Am

And gath - ered by most fra - gile pow'rs a - long the cen - tur - ies
And thefts from sat - el - lites and rings and bro - ken stars I drew,
Yet whirl the glow - ing wheels once more, and mix the bowl a - gain;
No ray is dimmed, no a - tom worn, my old - est force is new,

C Am C Am C/G G C

from race on race the rar - est flow'rs my wreath shall noth - ing miss.
and out of spent and ag - ed things I formed the world a - new.
seethe, Fate, the an - cient el - e - ments, heat, cold, and peace, and pain.
and fresh the rose on yon - der thorn gives back the heav'n's in dew.